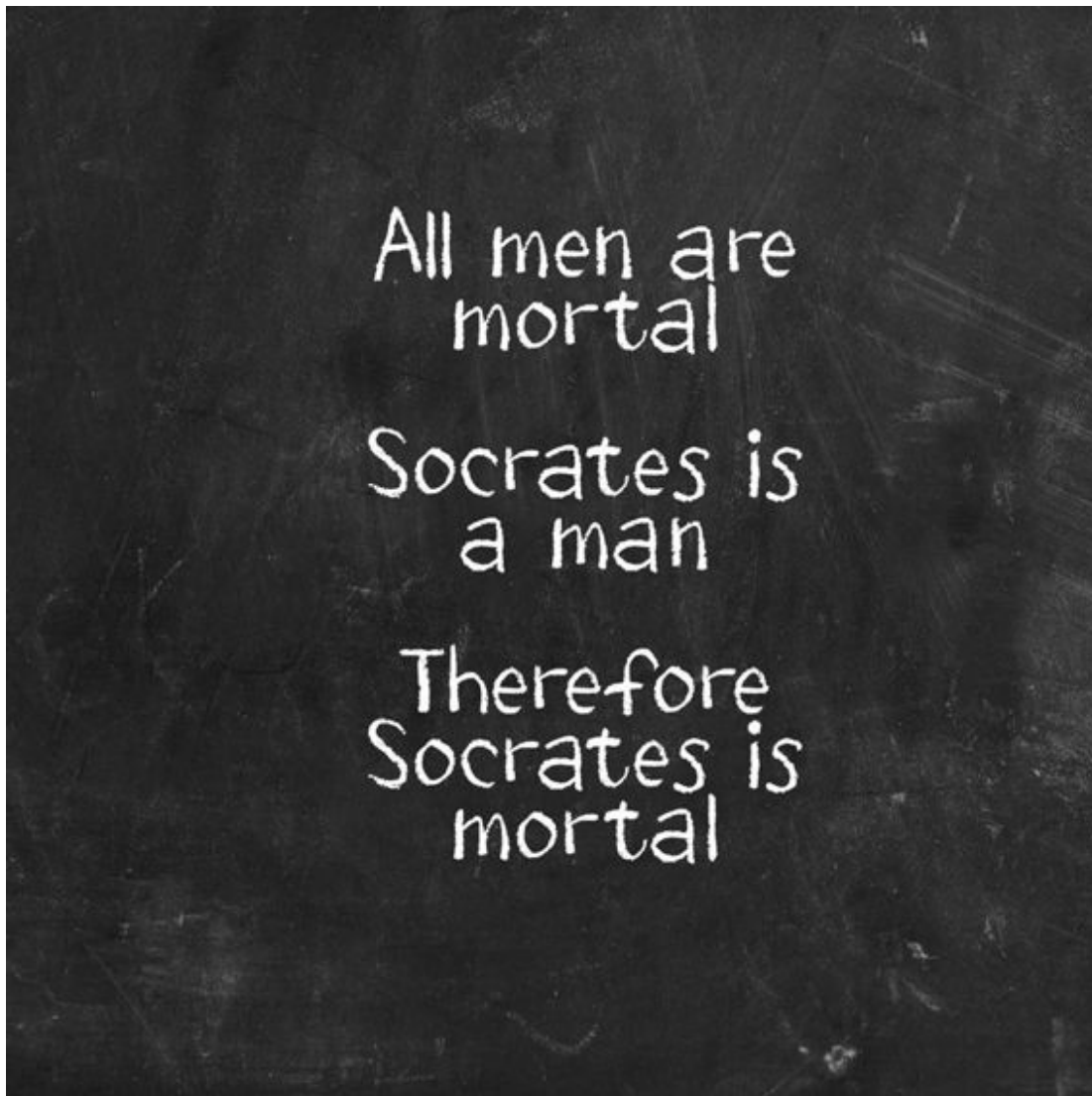


Logic



In seeking answers to questions about the universe and our place in it, philosophy is distinguished from religion or mere convention by its use of reasoning. A philosopher proposes ideas as a result of thought, and has to justify his or her assertions with rational argument. Various techniques have been devised to show whether an argument is valid or fallacious, forming the branch of philosophy known as logic.

In simple terms, logic is the process of inferring a conclusion from statements known as premises, either deriving a general principle from

specific examples (inductive reasoning) or reaching a conclusion from general statements (deductive reasoning). The classical form of logical argument, the syllogism, consisting of two premises and a conclusion, was formalized by Aristotle (see [Logic and the syllogism](#)) and remained the mainstay of philosophical logic until advances in mathematical logic brought in new ideas in the 19th century, and symbolic logic opened up new fields of philosophy in the 20th century.